



NEFAC 30 Minute Skills
April 16, 2024

Climate Reporting *Across Beats*

Annie Ropeik, independent climate journalist

How I became a climate reporter

- No formal science training, but always loved exploring and learning about the outdoors and nature
- Local general assignment reporting in places with deep ties to their environments and natural resources



Climate stories in New Hampshire, 2019-21

Where They Stand: Comparing The 2020 Democrats' Climate Change Proposals

New Hampshire Public Radio | By Sara Plourde, Annie Ropeik
Published December 3, 2019 at 6:00 AM EST

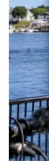
▶ LISTEN • 4:52



Dozens Arrested At Protest Outside New England's Largest Coal Power Plant

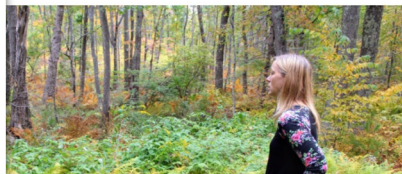
New Hampshire Public Radio | By Annie Ropeik
Published September 28, 2019 at 8:24 PM EDT

▶ LISTEN • 2:06



As Climate Change Drives Droughts, Water Conservation & Infrastructure Become Key

By Annie Ropeik
PM EDT



NEWS CULTURE MUSIC PODCASTS & SHOWS

SPECIAL SERIES
Environment And Energy Collaborative

Americans Are Moving To Escape Climate Impacts. Towns Expect More To Come

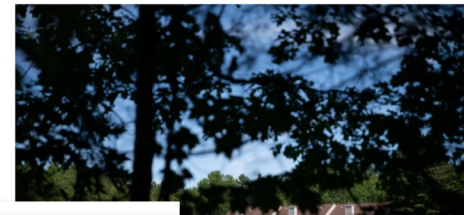
JANUARY 22, 2021 · 5:00 AM ET

By Annie Ropeik

White Mountain Forest Steps Up Wildfire Prevention Efforts In High-Risk Neighborhoods

New Hampshire Public Radio | By Annie Ropeik
Published July 14, 2021 at 9:21 AM EDT

▶ LISTEN • 5:36



Some Republicans See Missed Opportunity To Campaign On Climate Change In N.H.

New Hampshire Public Radio | By Annie Ropeik
Published October 30, 2020 at 6:00 AM EDT

▶ LISTEN • 5:02



Understanding climate change in 3 parts



Causes



Impacts



Responses

Via Lesley-Ann Dupigny-Giroux, Vermont state climatologist — SciLine's "Science essentials for political reporters" training, August 2019, Des Moines, Iowa

Ingredients to engaging climate stories



Science & data

What do we know, how do we know it and what's still uncertain? Show your work!



Human voices

Real-world, present-tense impacts & responses make the story relatable



What's at stake

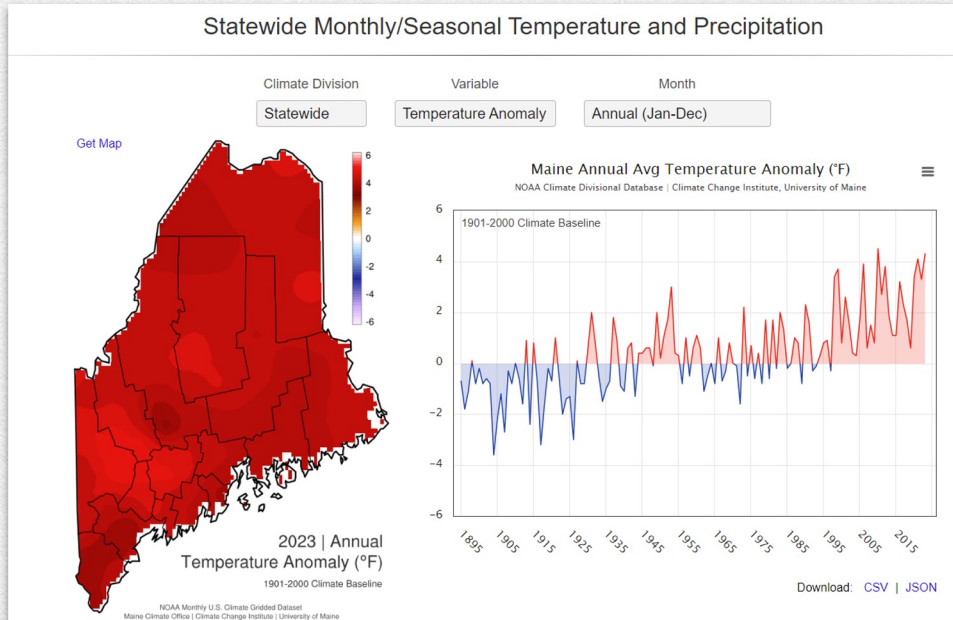
All climate solutions have trade-offs. We must also explain the cost of doing nothing



Intersections, equity & justice

Climate change is systemic — it's in everything, but won't be felt equally by all

"Climate is what you expect; weather is what you get"



Maine Climate Office / World Weather Attribution

World Weather Attribution

[Home](#) [About](#) [Analyses](#) [News](#) [Peer reviewed](#)

Dangerous humid heat in southern West Africa about 4°C hotter due to climate change

Latest analyses

Extreme rainfall

Reducing vulnerability and improved land management needed with increasing heavy rainfall in Mindanao Island, southern Philippines

Extreme rainfall

Climate change made the extreme rainfall associated with flooding in Midleton, Ireland more likely and more intense

In October 2023, County Cork was

Wildfire

Despite known coastal cooling trend, risk of deadly wildfires in central Chile increasing with changing land management in a warming climate



Climate science & data resources

Learn the basics, find out the topline local impacts, trends and uncertainties, and create shorthand phrases to help you explain climate change quickly and easily in any story:

NASA Climate Change — go-to language on what we know and how: science.nasa.gov/climate-change

National Climate Assessment — check topline local impacts and talk to local researchers from your area's regional section: nca2023.globalchange.gov

NOAA Sea Level Rise viewer — interactive map: coast.noaa.gov/slr

Find your **state climatologist** and ask them to show you the available data on observed climate changes, key impacts and expected trends for your state: stateclimate.org

Great **climate science overview** from MIT: climateprimer.mit.edu

Climate Central — quick-hit data analysis and graphics about local climate trends, plus a simple attribution tool for checking how much climate change influenced daily local temperatures: www.climatecentral.org

SciLine — find a scientific expert source on just about anything: www.sciline.org

Balancing challenge with opportunity

ENERGY NEWS NETWORK

SUBSCRIBE



NORTHEAST

Making Maine's next generation of housing fossil-free — and affordable

Maine has a unique opportunity to tackle its housing crisis and the climate crisis at the same time, advocates say, but it will need to be careful to manage costs and balance priorities.

Part of my 2023 series for the MIT Environmental Solutions Journalism fellowship - open for 2024 apps thru April 28 - highly recommend! environmentalsolutions.mit.edu

ENERGY NEWS NETWORK

NORTHEAST

Months after devastating floods, Vermont renews efforts to aid climate-friendly rebuilds

A program saw mixed success encouraging heat pumps and other upgrades in damaged homes in the wake of the disaster. Now groups are revisiting those same residents to work on long-term improvements.



by Annie Ropeik
March 20, 2024



Amid progress on electric vehicles, political setbacks frustrate advocates in Maine, Connecticut

Transportation is the biggest contributor to climate change in New England, and EVs are only one part of the solution in both rural and urban settings, advocates say.



Finding climate story ideas on other beats

Climate Vulnerability Index — helps visualize and quantify existing issues like disease rates, housing, income inequality, food systems, air quality, infrastructure funding, overlaid with related climate risks, down to the census tract level: map.climatevulnerabilityindex.org

Yale Climate Opinion Maps — far fewer people reject climate science than you might think, plus lots of other interesting polling data on technologies, policy ideas, beliefs: climatecommunication.yale.edu

Climate Herald — local climate plans and rolling public input opportunities to cover: climateherald.org (also read your [state's climate plan](#) if they have one; if not, that's a story you should be doing)

EPA Greenhouse Gas Inventory Data Explorer — see emissions over time by source, state & more: cfpub.epa.gov/ghgdata/inventoryexplorer

Energy Information Agency — all the energy data by state, sector, fuel, etc that you could ever need and so much more: www.eia.gov (make friends with an energy wonk and get their help navigating this)

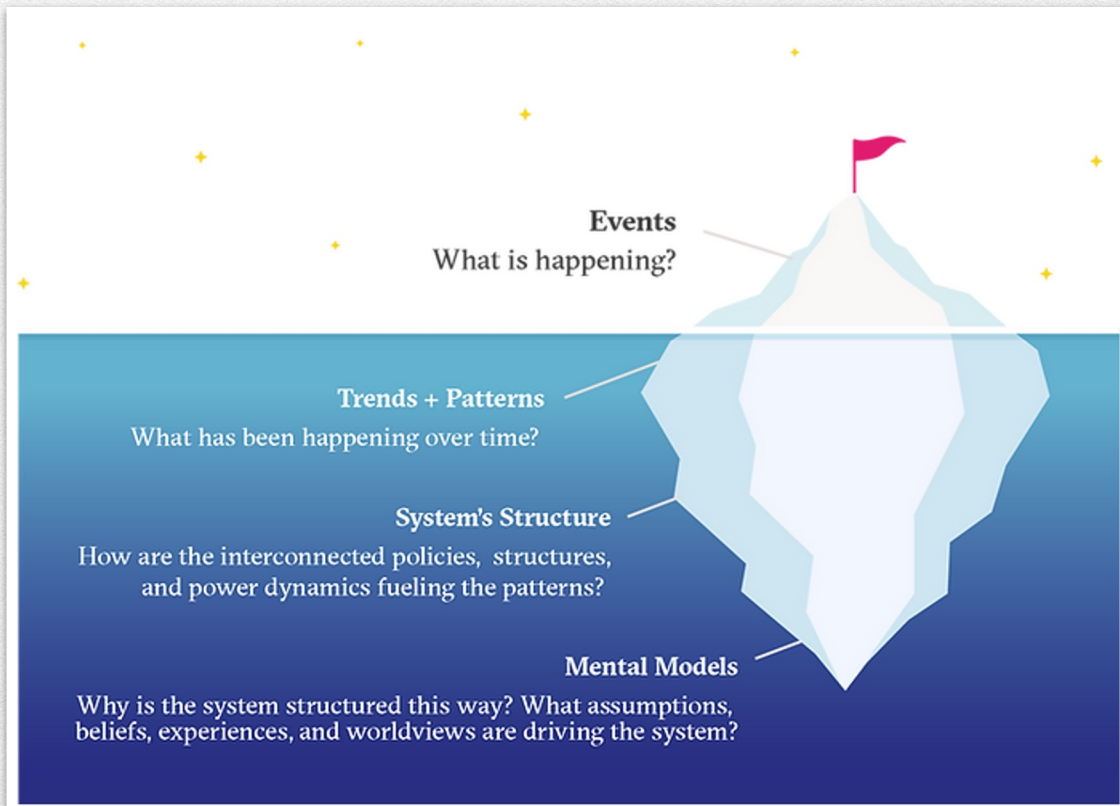
Rewiring America — advocacy group with energy transition explainers geared toward consumers, including on the Inflation Reduction Act: www.rewiringamerica.org

Systems thinking approaches

If you write about something influenced by climate change and don't look for or explain that connection, even if only in a sentence, you're not telling a fully accurate or useful story.

Dig deeper: What systemic questions do you ask in stories you cover now? What do you need to learn to ask similar questions about climate change?

Graphic from Systems Thinking for Journalists, a great tool for mapping stories & beats from the New School's Journalism + Design lab. Try it:
www.systemsjournalismdesign.com



Thanks!

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